

WarehouseGPT Performance Investigation Guide

Purpose of the Performance Investigation Guide

This guide is used by WarehouseGPT to support root-cause investigation when users ask why a warehouse, shift, manager or team is underperforming.

Each scenario includes business impact, likely causes, investigation steps and recommended actions.

Scenario: Low PickRate

Business Impact: Reduced throughput, increased labor cost and delayed service.

Likely Causes:

- Training gaps
- Poor slotting
- Excessive travel distance
- Replenishment delay
- Equipment downtime

Investigation Steps:

- Compare by shift, team leader and employee
- Check IdleSelectionTime_pct
- Check EquipmentDowntime_Min
- Compare against peer warehouses

Recommended Actions:

- Run training refresh
- Review slotting
- Rebalance workload
- Escalate process blockers

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: High Overtime

Business Impact: Higher cost, employee fatigue and productivity instability.

Likely Causes:

- Understaffing
- Absenteeism
- Forecast error
- Unexpected volume spike

- Low productivity

Investigation Steps:

- Compare ForecastVolume vs ActualVolume
- Check Absenteeism_pct
- Review shift mix
- Compare with PickRate

Recommended Actions:

- Add temporary labor
- Rebalance shifts
- Improve forecasting
- Review workforce plan

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: High Idle Time

Business Impact: Lost productive time and reduced labor utilization.

Likely Causes:

- Delayed replenishment
- System downtime
- Task release issue
- Equipment wait

Investigation Steps:

- Check ReplenishmentRate
- Check EquipmentDowntime_Min
- Compare idle time by shift
- Review pick-wave timing

Recommended Actions:

- Improve replenishment planning
- Fix equipment issue
- Adjust wave release timing

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: Low Inventory Accuracy

Business Impact: Higher picking errors and service risk.

Likely Causes:

- Cycle count gaps
- Stock misplacement
- Inbound errors
- Process non-compliance

Investigation Steps:

- Check PickingErrorRate_pct
- Review affected warehouses
- Analyze trend by month

Recommended Actions:

- Start cycle count
- Correct stock records
- Review inventory process

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: High Picking Errors

Business Impact: Customer complaints, rework and lower service quality.

Likely Causes:

- Training issues
- Poor labeling
- Inventory mismatch
- Process non-compliance

Investigation Steps:

- Compare by team and employee
- Check inventory accuracy
- Review error trend

Recommended Actions:

- Training refresh
- Quality sampling
- Process audit

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: Low On-Time Shipment

Business Impact: Customer service risk and escalation pressure.

Likely Causes:

- Capacity shortage
- Picking delay
- Packing bottleneck
- High volume
- High downtime

Investigation Steps:

- Review CapacityUtilization_pct
- Check ActualVolume
- Check overtime and PickRate

Recommended Actions:

- Create recovery plan
- Prioritize service risk orders
- Add dispatch capacity

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: High Absenteeism

Business Impact: Staffing instability, overtime pressure and performance decline.

Likely Causes:

- Seasonality
- Workforce engagement issue
- Illness
- Scheduling problem

Investigation Steps:

- Compare absenteeism by DC and shift
- Check overtime impact
- Review productivity trend

Recommended Actions:

- Activate backup labor
- Review attendance plan
- Escalate HR support

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: Safety Incident Increase

Business Impact: Employee risk, process disruption and compliance risk.

Likely Causes:

- Unsafe process
- Training gap
- Equipment issue
- Fatigue

Investigation Steps:

- Review incidents by shift
- Compare with overtime
- Check affected process area

Recommended Actions:

- Run safety audit
- Update training
- Pause risky process if needed

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: Equipment Downtime

Business Impact: Operational blockage, idle time and throughput loss.

Likely Causes:

- Maintenance gaps
- System issue
- Material handling equipment failure

Investigation Steps:

- Check EquipmentDowntime_Min
- Compare idle time and PickRate
- Review affected DCs

Recommended Actions:

- Escalate maintenance
- Create workaround plan
- Review preventive maintenance

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.

Scenario: Capacity Constraint

Business Impact: Service risk and operational congestion.

Likely Causes:

- High actual volume
- Limited space
- Labor shortage
- Dispatch bottleneck

Investigation Steps:

- Check CapacityUtilization_pct
- Compare forecast vs actual
- Review on-time shipment

Recommended Actions:

- Use overflow capacity
- Reprioritize workload
- Escalate regional support

Escalation Path: Team Leader -> Shift Manager -> DC Manager -> Regional Director if issue remains critical.